Thursday, November 30

Two Hamas terrorists killed four people at a bus station in Jerusalem and were shot dead. Negotiations about another exchange of Israeli hostages for Palestinian prisoners are beginning, but it doesn't seem that the ceasefire will hold much longer.

The coalition government does not enforce any sanctions regarding settler violence against Palestinians in the occupied West Bank. The perpetrators should be put on trial like any other criminals and punished according to the law. Ben-Gvir and his party would oppose this, of course, and probably so would Smotrich. Isn't it high time to get rid of these two? As Netanyahu would probably oppose any disruption of his coalition, he should also be ousted as soon as possible. The trouble is that a change of government in wartime is hardly feasible. Secretary of State Blinken discussed the settler violence with Mahmoud Abbas, and agreed that punishment was necessary.

The ceasefire will be extended through today and will bring the release of ten more women hostages and the liberation of thirty Palestinian prisoners. This is the penultimate release of female hostages under the existing conditions. After tomorrow, the group of hostages should include older Israeli males; Hamas may ask for the liberation of more prisoners for the release of each male hostage and that may put an end to the negotiations and the ceasefire. The Americans seem to understand the Israeli rationale for a resumption of the fighting but insist on the need to spare civilian lives as much as possible and allow for the continuation of humanitarian aid for Gaza.

There is a growing possibility that under pressure from within the administration, President Biden will have to put tougher conditions on its military assistance to Israel. From the outset, and more so as time goes by, Israel has been losing the fight for world opinion. In part, the massive bombing used by the IDF led to this and, in part, the upsurge of